

Thursday, 2 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 25° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 21° 16°	MANCHESTER Drizzle 19° 14°	GLASGOW Drizzle 17° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Judge 'wrong' to spare boy rapists from custody, court told.

Three teenage boys convicted of rape should have been detained, the Court of Appeal hears.

UK · NEWS
- 2

Nowak case officers face gross misconduct investigation.

Henry Nowak, 18, was handcuffed as he lay dying after being stabbed by Vickrum Digwa in December 2025.

UK · NEWS
- 3

CPS considering charges against MP after rape arrest.

Dan Norris says he "vigorously" denies the allegations, which include rape and sexual assault.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

Tens of thousands rush for tickets to see Bayeux Tapestry in UK.

The historic masterpiece will travel from France to go on display on UK soil for the first time.

UK · NEWS
- 5

Two dead after plane crashed during flight experience.

The two-seat Cessna plane comes down off Mill Lane in High Ongar during a 30-minute flying experience on Tuesday.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1

Village People frontman Victor Willis dies aged 74.

Victor Willis was the band's frontman and co-wrote most of their hit songs including YMCA.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

Chris Brown ordered to pay housekeeper \$13m after dog attack.

Maria Aliva was left with scarring, vision loss and nerve damage following the attack in December 2020.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

Wonka Netflix show faces backlash for AI-generated Gene Wilder voice.

The actor, who died in 2016, appears in the Netflix show with the consent of his estate.

SHOWBIZ · UK

4

PlayStation will stop releasing games on discs in 2028.

The firm said future games would still be sold in shops, but they would come with a digital code only.

SHOWBIZ · UK

5

Romesh Ranganathan 'gutted' over bakery closure.

Coughlans Bakery says it has gone into voluntary liquidation over hikes in national insurance and business rates.

SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

- 1 Should England have been awarded a penalty?.**
England's appeals for a penalty are waved away after DR Congo goalkeeper Lionel Mpasi appears to bring down England's Harry Kane.
SPORT · UK
- 2 Nottingham Forest set to replace Pereira with Glasner.**
Vitor Pereira is poised to leave Nottingham Forest with the club ready to appoint former Crystal Palace boss Oliver Glasner as his successor.
SPORT · UK
- 3 Rate the players as England face DR Congo.**
Rate the England and DR Congo players out of 10 below and come back 30 minutes after full-time to see the final ratings.
SPORT · UK
- 4 'Just what the doctor ordered' - Sinner overcomes tricky Borges test.**
Jannik Sinner's tricky start to his Wimbledon title defence continues as he overcomes a stern second-round test against Portugal's Nuno Borges.
SPORT · UK
- 5 Brighton agree club record £46m Vuskovic deal.**
Brighton have third bid accepted by Tottenham and will pay club record £46m for highly-rated young defender Luka Vuskovic
SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking a 'micro-break' to look at something green can boost your mood and productivity.**
Researchers found that even a quick glance at a plant or a garden view helps reduce stress and refocus the mind during a busy day. It seems a little bit of nature is a powerful pick-me-up!
- 2 The enduring appeal of 'jigsaw puzzles' is seeing a resurgence, with many finding them a perfect way to unwind and unplug.**
Sales of jigsaw puzzles have soared as people look for screen-free activities that offer a satisfying sense of accomplishment. It's a wonderful way to challenge the mind and relax at the same time.
- 3 Experts are encouraging us to embrace the simple joy of 'sketching' everyday objects.**
It doesn't require artistic talent, just a willingness to observe and capture the world around you. This mindful practice can improve focus and appreciation for the little details in life.
- 4 A growing number of people are discovering the delights of 'wild swimming' in natural bodies of water.**
From lakes to rivers and even the sea, the refreshing dip is praised for its invigorating benefits, both physically and mentally. Always remember to swim safely and check local conditions!
- 5 The trend of 'upcycling old furniture' is gaining popularity, as people transform pre-loved pieces into unique household items.**
Instead of buying new, many are enjoying the creative challenge of giving old chairs, tables, and cabinets a fresh lease of life. It's good for the planet and your pocket!
- 6 Research indicates that 'listening to rain' can significantly improve sleep quality and reduce anxiety.**
The gentle, rhythmic sound of falling rain creates a 'pink noise' effect, which is thought to calm the brain and promote deeper, more restorative sleep. So, next rainy day, open a window!
- 7 The humble 'picnic' is being celebrated as a wonderful way to reconnect with nature and loved ones.**
Whether it's in a park, on the beach, or even in your own garden, packing a simple basket of goodies and eating outdoors offers a delightful break from routine. Don't forget the blanket!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if something smells bad, even if we know it probably doesn't help?

ANSWER: ...WAFING IT TOWARDS THEIR NOSE WITH THEIR HAND.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'drawer or cupboard' in the kitchen that is absolutely full of miscellaneous items and random bits?

ANSWER: ...THE DREADED 'JUNK DRAWER'.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'new favourite walking route' right on your doorstep, and it feels like you've found a hidden gem?

Perhaps it's a path you'd never noticed before, or a quiet lane that's become your go-to for a breath of fresh air. What's your favourite local walking discovery?

- We all have those 'little rituals' that help us wind down at the end of a busy day, don't we?

Maybe it's a specific type of tea, a certain playlist, or a quick read before bed. What's your go-to end-of-day wind-down routine?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that flamingos are not born pink? They get their distinctive colour from the beta-carotene in the brine shrimp and algae they eat.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights can make a distinct crackling sound, like static electricity, that can occasionally be heard by observers on the ground.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£69 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£69 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Hot water freezes faster than cold water, a phenomenon known as the Mpemba effect.
- There are more possible permutations of a standard deck of 52 cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- The world's largest living organism is a fungus in Oregon, USA, spanning over 2,200 acres.
- Humans share 50% of their DNA with bananas.
- The dot over the lowercase 'i' and 'j' is called a tittle.

On this day

Day 183 of the year, 182 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aberoh and Atom (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Bernardino Realino; Christian feast day: Blessed Eugénie Joubert; Christian feast day: Feast of the Visitation (Anglicanism; Levoča at Mariánska hora). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1925 — Marvin Rainwater, American singer-songwriter (died 2013)
- 1969 — Tim Rodber, English rugby player
- 1993 — Vince Staples, American rapper and actor
- 1956 — Jerry Hall, American model and actress
- 1949 — Roy Bittan, American rock piano and accordion player (E Street Band)
- 1939 — Paul Williams, American singer and choreographer (died 1973)
- 1937 — Polly Holliday, American actress (died 2025)
- 1949 — Greg Brown, American musician

THE DAY TODAY

- 2024 — A stampede during a religious event in Uttar Pradesh, India, leaves at least 121 people dead and 150 others injured.
- 1986 — Aeroflot Flight 2306 crashes while attempting an emergency landing at Syktyvkar Airport in Syktyvkar, in present-day Komi Republic, Russia, killing 54 people.
- 1890 — The U.S. Congress passes the Sherman Antitrust Act.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1990 — In the 1990 Mecca tunnel tragedy, 1,400 Muslim pilgrims are suffocated to death and trampled upon in a pedestrian tunnel leading to the holy city of Mecca.
- 1986 — Aeroflot Flight 2306 crashes while attempting an emergency landing at Syktyvkar Airport in Syktyvkar, in present-day Komi Republic, Russia, killing 54 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1494 — Age of Discovery: The Treaty of Tordesillas is ratified by Spain.
- 1582 — Battle of Yamazaki: Toyotomi Hideyoshi defeats Akechi Mitsuhide.

- 1921 — World War I: U.S. President Warren G. Harding signs the Knox–Porter Resolution formally ending the war between the United States and Germany.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 184 of the year, 181 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anatolius of Constantinople; Christian feast day: Anatolius of Laodicea; Christian feast day: Dathus; Christian feast day: Germanus of Man. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Gary Waldhorn, British actor (died 2022)
- 1952 — Laura Branigan, American singer-songwriter (died 2004)
- 1943 — Kurtwood Smith, American actor
- 1958 — Siân Lloyd, Welsh meteorologist and journalist
- 1973 — Patrick Wilson, American actor
- 1946 — Johnny Lee, American singer and guitarist
- 1930 — Tommy Tedesco, American guitarist (died 1997)
- 1970 — Audra McDonald, American actress and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1967 — The Aden Emergency: The Battle of the Crater in which the British Argyll and Sutherland Highlanders retake the Crater district following the Arab Police mutiny.
- 1884 — Dow Jones & Company publishes its first stock average.
- 1938 — World speed record for a steam locomotive is set in England, by the Mallard, which reaches a speed of 125.88 miles per hour (202.58 km/h).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The SS United States sets sail on her maiden voyage to Southampton. During the voyage, the ship takes the Blue Riband away from the RMS Queen Mary.
- 1863 — American Civil War: The final day of the Battle of Gettysburg culminates with Pickett's Charge.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)